

Aortic Dissection



Section I: Scenario Demographics

Scenario Title:	Aortic Dissection		
Date of Development:	(10/01/2016)		
Target Learning Group:	☐ Juniors (PGY 1 - 2)	☐ Seniors (PGY $\geq$ 3)	☒ All Groups

Section II: Scenario Developers

Scenario Developer(s):	Martin Kuuskne
Affiliations/Institution(s):	University of Toronto
Contact E-mail (optional):	martin.kuuskne@gmail.com

Section III: Curriculum Integration

Learning Goals & Objectives	
Educational Goal:	To recognize and manage a critically ill patient with aortic dissection and its potential cardiac complications.
CRM Objectives:	1) Mobilize appropriate human resources in the work-up and disposition of aortic dissection. 2) Maintain and actively verbalize a wide differential diagnosis for the critically ill patient with chest pain. 3) Set priorities dynamically as the patient's status changes.
Medical Objectives:	1) Appropriately manage hypertension in the setting of aortic dissection with blood pressure and heart rate targets. 2) Recognize EKG manifestations of RCA involvement and resultant ischemia in the setting of aortic dissection. 3) Appropriately apply the ACLS algorithm for unstable bradycardia and asystole.

Case Summary: Brief Summary of Case Progression and Major Events

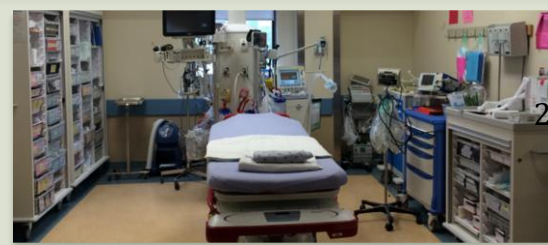
A 66 year old female with a history of smoking, HTN and T2DM presents with syncope while walking her dog. She complains of retrosternal chest pain radiating to her jaw. She will become increasingly bradycardic and hypotensive, requiring the team to mobilize resources in order to facilitate diagnosis and management of an aortic dissection.

References

Marx, J. A., Hockberger, R. S., Walls, R. M., & Adams, J. (2013). *Rosen's emergency medicine: Concepts and clinical practice*. St. Louis: Mosby.
<http://lifeinthefastlane.com/cc/acute-aortic-dissection/>



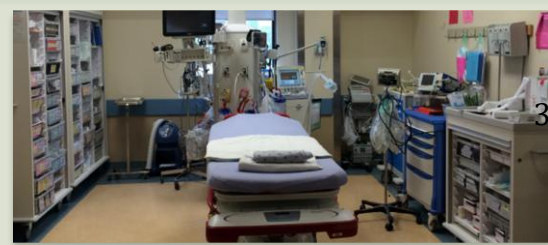
Aortic Dissection



Section IV: Scenario Script

A. Clinical Vignette: To Read Aloud at Beginning of Case			
You are working the day shift at a tertiary-care hospital. A 66-year old female is being wheeled into the resuscitation bay with a history of as syncopal episode. No family members or friends are present with the patient.			
B. Scenario Cast & Realism			
Patient:	☒ Computerized Mannequin	Realism: <i>Select most important dimension(s)</i>	☒ Conceptual
	☐ Mannequin		☐ Physical
	☐ Standardized Patient		☐ Emotional/Experiential
	☐ Hybrid		☐ Other:
	☐ Task Trainer		☐ N/A
Confederates	Brief Description of Role		
RN	To assist if asked, provide relevant history and current status of patient. Patient was walking her dog and had a syncopal episode witnessed by bystanders who called EMS.		
C. Required Monitors			
☒ EKG Leads/Wires	☒ Temperature Probe	☐ Central Venous Line	
☒ NIBP Cuff	☒ Defibrillator Pads	☐ Capnography	
☒ Pulse Oximeter	☐ Arterial Line	☐ Other:	
D. Required Equipment			
☒ Gloves	☒ Nasal Prongs	☐ Scalpel	
☒ Stethoscope	☒ Venturi Mask	☐ Tube Thoracostomy Kit	
☒ Defibrillator	☒ Non-Rebreather Mask	☐ Cricothyroidotomy Kit	
☒ IV Bags/Lines	☒ Bag Valve Mask	☐ Thoracotomy Kit	
☒ IV Push Medications	☒ Laryngoscope	☐ Central Line Kit	
☒ PO Tabs	☐ Video Assisted Laryngoscope	☐ Arterial Line Kit	
☐ Blood Products	☒ ET Tubes	☐ Other:	
☐ Intraosseous Set-up	☐ LMA	☐ Other:	
E. Moulage			
Mannequin dressed in female outdoor clothing			
F. Approximate Timing			
Set-Up:	10 min	Scenario:	10 min
		Debriefing:	15 min

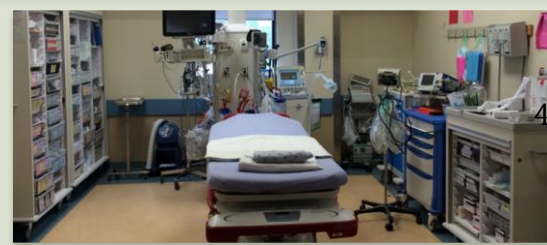
Aortic Dissection



Section V: Patient Data and Baseline State

A. Patient Profile and History					
Patient Name: Dorothy Williams		Age: 66		Weight: 50 kg	
Gender: ☐ M ☒ F		Code Status: Full			
Chief Complaint: Syncope					
History of Presenting Illness: Walking the dog outside and suddenly fainted, seen by passerby who called ambulance.					
Past Medical History:	HTN		Medications:	Amlodipine	
	T2DM			Metformin	
	No prev MI/CVA/PE			ASA	
Allergies: NKDA					
Social History: 30 pack year smoker					
Family History: None contributory					
Review of Systems:	CNS:	None			
	HEENT:	None			
	CVS:	Retrosternal chest pain radiating to right jaw, constant, sharp, x30 mins			
	RESP:	None (no SOB, no hemoptysis)			
	GI:	None			
	GU:	None			
	MSK:	None	INT:	None	
B. Baseline Simulator State and Physical Exam					
☒ No Monitor Display		☐ Monitor On, no data displayed		☐ Monitor on Standard Display	
HR: 110/min	BP: 210/100 (160/80 left arm only if asked)		RR: 20/min	O ₂ Sat: 99%	
Rhythm: Sinus tach	T: 36.5°C		Glucose: 5.0 mmol/L	GCS: 15 (E4 V5 M6)	
General Status: No acute distress, no respiratory distress					
CNS:	Normal				
HEENT:	Normal				
CVS:	Diastolic III/VI murmur				
RESP:	Bi-basilar crackles				
ABDO:	Normal				
GU:	Normal				
MSK:	Normal	INT:	Normal		

Aortic Dissection



Section VI: Scenario Progression

Scenario States, Modifiers and Triggers			
Patient State	Patient Status	Learner Actions, Modifiers & Triggers to Move to Next State	
1. Baseline State Rhythm: Sinus tach HR: 110/min BP: 210/100 (R) 160/80 (L) only if asked RR: 20/min O ₂ Sat: 99% T: 36.5°C	Alert. Complaining of chest pain	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Full set of vitals, monitors ☐ ECG ☐ CXR ☐ Start 2 Large Bore IV lines ☐ IV Labetolol OR ☐ IV Esmolol + Nitroprusside ☐ Orders Emergent CT chest	<u>Modifiers</u> <i>Changes to patient condition based on learner action</i> - Give negative inotrope (HR→85, BP→150/96) - Give vasodilator (HR→85, BP→135/80) - Give NTG SL (BP→200/100 then increases) <u>Triggers</u> <i>For progression to next state</i> - Give heparin → 4. Bradycardia-Asystolic arrest - 4 minutes → 2. Increasing Chest Pain
2. Increasing Chest Pain HR→50 BP→90/60 and decreasing	Complaining of severe chest pain	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Repeat EKG (Mobitz I, inferior STE) ☐ Discontinue any prior β-blockers or vasodilators. ☐ Give IV fluids ☐ Atropine IV ☐ Call for CT chest (if not yet) ☐ Bedside U/S for PCE	<u>Modifiers</u> - Give IV fluids → BP 100/65 - Give atropine → no change <u>Triggers</u> - 3 minutes → 3. Unstable Bradycardia
3. Unstable Bradycardia HR→40/min BP→70/30 RR→12/min	Acute distress	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Initiate intubation ☐ Atropine IV ☐ Initiate transcutaneous pacing ☐ Consider IV inotropic/chronotropic agents ☐ Call ICU ☐ Bedside ultrasound for PCE ☐ Call for TEE ☐ Consult Cardiac surgery	<u>Modifiers</u> - Give atropine → no change - Give IV chronotropic agents → BP 90/50 - Transcutaneous pacing → BP 90/50 <u>Triggers</u> - END SCENARIO PRN with TEE or consultant arrival
4. Bradycardia-Asystolic arrest Rhythm→asystole HR→0/min BP→0/0 RR→0/min O ₂ Sat→0%	Non-responsive	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ High Quality CPR ☐ Epinephrine 1amp q3-5min ☐ ACLS ☐ Crash Intubation ☐ Monitor capnography	<u>Modifiers</u> <u>Triggers</u> - 1 st round of CPR and epi given → 3. Unstable Bradycardia - Total scenario >10 minutes → END SCENARIO

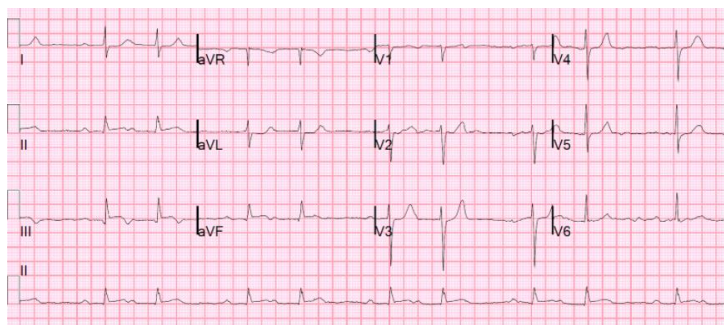
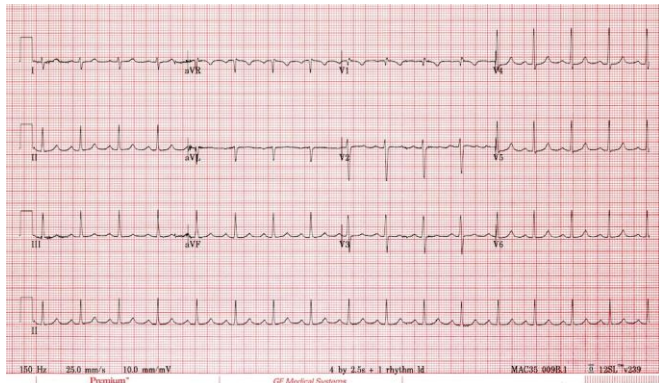
Aortic Dissection



Section VII: Supporting Documents, Laboratory Results, & Multimedia

Laboratory Results						
Na: 137	K: 4.9	Cl: 101	HCO ₃ : 24	BUN:	Cr:	Glu: 5.0
Ca:		Mg:		PO ₄ :		Albumin:
VBG	pH: 7.23	PCO ₂ : 30	PO ₂ :	HCO ₃ : 25	Lactate:2.9	
WBC: 9.0		Hg: 140		Hct:		Plt: 360
Troponin: 358						

Images (ECGs, CXRs, etc.)



Retrieved from:
<https://radiopaedia.org/articles/aortic-dissection>

Ultrasound Video Files (if applicable)

Aortic Dissection



6

Section VIII: Debriefing Guide

General Debriefing Plan	
☐ Individual	☒ Group
☐ With Video	☒ Without Video
Objectives	
Educational Goal:	To recognize and manage a critically ill patient with aortic dissection and its potential cardiac complications.
CRM Objectives:	1) Mobilize appropriate human resources in the work-up and disposition of aortic dissection. 2) Maintain and actively verbalize a wide differential diagnosis for the critically ill patient with chest pain. 3) Set priorities dynamically as patient status changes.
Medical Objectives:	1) Appropriately manage hypertension in the setting of aortic dissection appropriate blood pressure and heart rate targets. 2) Recognize EKG manifestations of RCA involvement and resultant ischemia in the setting of aortic dissection. 3) Appropriately apply the ACLS algorithm for unstable bradycardia and asystole.
Sample Questions for Debriefing	
1. At what point did you suspect this was a dissection? How common is syncope a presentation of dissection? (9%) AMI?(7%) Pulmonary Embolism? (10%) 2. What other items were on your differential? 3. What is the most time efficient way to rule out items on the differential for chest pain? 4. What is the best test that can be performed most EDs to rule in a dissection in the unstable patient? 5. How did your management priorities change for this patient with the change in vital signs? 6. Did the team feel like a cohesive unit today? Were there any challenges to your leadership or communication?	
Key Moments	
Recognition of aortic dissection	
Change in management when patient became hypotensive	
Initiation of transcutaneous pacing when patient became bradycardic	